

**WINTER
IN
OUR
BONES**



**WATER
TO
OUR
SOULS**



is a folksy musical that follows Lulu and Petoskey, a Dearborn girl and Yooper boy, fight a data center to save their grandparents' lake house and the world.

WHY MI? WHY ME?

Where David was Born. Family is Here.

His whole personality is using his hand to point at his favorite places on the Mitten.

The Inspiration? Grief and Hope at Home.

In 2026, after a series of suicides of his theatre hometown and college friends off the Mackinac Bridge and his own hospitalization, he returned home to camp at the MacGregor family reunion (third time). The great-grandparents' Elk Rapids lake house won't be around for long. With that in mind and David putting Michigan references in all his musicals, he may as well tell the stories of his lively family and late friends for stage and the world.

No Data Centers Near Our Drinking Water!

Its constructions are burdening the Great Lakes region. It is our duty to educate the public of its negative effects on our health and environment.



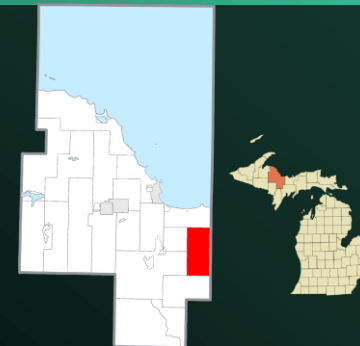
MEET LULU AND PETOSKEY

The folksy musical dramedy is set during a family reunion where two rival cousins must save their grandparents' historic lake house (and the whole town of Elk Rapids) from a data center.

It explores silent grief, hands-on creativity in the modern world, the working class, immigrant experience, nature, cultural disconnection of the peninsulas, and what it means to be a Michigander. 🖐️

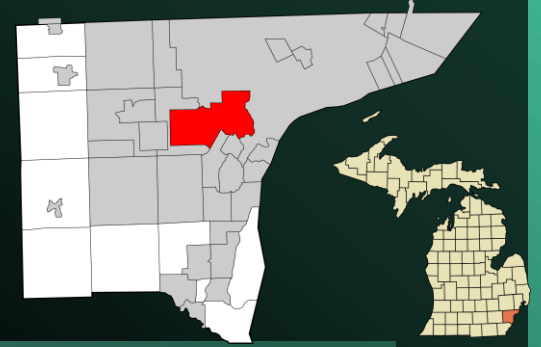


PETOSKEY VANDAM



Petoskey a 13-year-old farm boy from Skandia and the goofiest of Willy and Milly's grandchildren. Besides his mom Liz, the only connection to his extended family happens on Harbor Days in Elk Rapids. He never met his deceased dad. To honor Petey, his son wears his heart-shaped Petoskey necklace with an elk symbol and awakens folks with his Mitten Song.

LULU ABUGHOSH



Lulu is a 13-year-old city girl from Dearborn and the brightest of Willy and Milly grandkids, yet she is trollface personified. She hopes to beat cousin Petoskey in their annual rare rocks collection. She is writing a musical titled *Dearborn*, about a family of deer navigating the anthropomorphic Great Lakes. She plays banjo and is Iggy Pop's biggest fan. Her name is Arabic meaning "pearl."

THE VANDAMS FAMILY

GRAMMY MILLY & GRAMPY WILLY VANDAM

4th wall-breaking parents of Cherry, Perry, Petey, Shelby, who own the Elk Lake house in Elk Rapids. As automotive workers, their prized possession is a Ford Model T.

LIZZIE & PETEY VANDAM

Petoskey's mom and dad. Before his birth, Petey took his life at the Mackinac Bridge during the 2008 recession.

CHERRY JACOBOWITZ

Creative Oldest
Jacob's Mom

PERRY VANDAM

Nerdy Middle
The Crazy Aunt

SHELBY ABUGHOSH

Lonely Youngest
Lulu's Mom

JACOB JACOBOWITZ

Lulu and Petoskey's cousin who is on *The Addams Family* national tour and the 2022 Harbor Days Grand Marshall.

LIBERTY & BAILEY

Cousins from Hell... Michigan.

JASPER TRAN

Petoskey's godfather and Petey's childhood best friend. His family runs the Elk Rapids BANH Michigan restaurant.



The real-life MacGregor family
on Harbor Days, August 2026

AMANDA WAYLAND (Villain)



The CEO of Turkey Ventures who created afterlife.ai whose goal is to turn the Elk Lake neighborhood into a data center. At Hope College, she was an art school rival of Cherry, before getting expelled for using Photoshop. So, she sees the Vandam family's hands-on creativity as inferior to the efficiency of AI. The Vandams describe her as a turkey vulture. But like most of the world, there is one thing she likes more than data and that is a cool rock, which Petoskey holds.

MUSIC OF MICHIGAN

FOLK

Banjo, lots of banjo. David writes in this genre a ton. He finds inspiration in The Milk Carton Kids.

HIP HOP

Much of this is in Lulu's character.

JAZZ

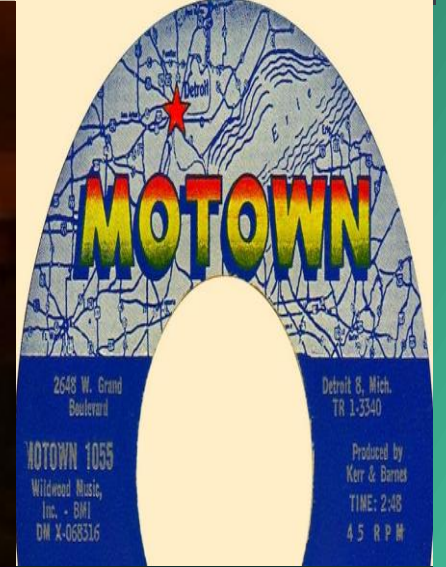
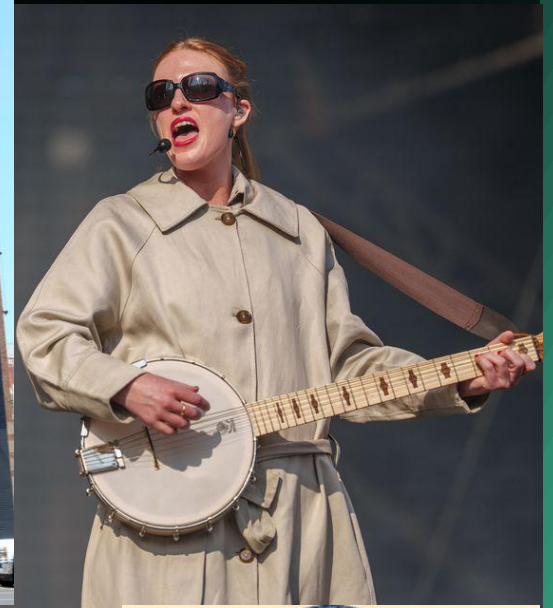
David is finding inspiration in his favorite jazz composer, Tommy Flanagan of Detroit.

POP

This is David's preferred genre. He was raised on Madonna (from Saginaw). He will bring even more Motown into this.

ROCK

This is Michigan after all!



MICHIGAN'S THEMES

NAYAANO (MAIN THEME)

Nayaano-nibiimaang Gichigamiin (Ojibwe: "The Five Freshwater Seas"). The Great Lakes (Huron, Ontario, Michigan, Erie, Superior) each have their own melodic phrase. David uses tritonic phrasing in mind (referencing Triton, Greek god of the sea). The string parts is to sound like rusty rudders of a boat.

WATER SPIRITS (CHILDHOOD THEME)

David places parallel 4ths/5ths all about to show the splashiness of spirituality in the childlike sense.

LAKE GIANTS (ADULTHOOD THEME)

David has the melodic journey mainly spiral down then end with hope, much like life as an adult.

David often derives music in pentatonic scales, found mainly in Indigenous and Eastern culture.

LINK TO PLAYBACK OF SCORES



The musical score is divided into three sections, each with a tempo marking and instrument parts.

Section 1: Sweetly Moderato

- Tambourine:** 6/8 time, starting with a 4-measure rest, then playing a rhythmic pattern.
- Marimba:** 6/8 time, starting with a 5-measure rest, then playing a melodic line. Dynamics include *ppp* and *mf*. Chords *Em* and *G* are indicated.

Section 2: Aimlessly Andante

- Piano:** 6/8 time, playing a slow, sustained melodic line. Chords *B*, *C#m*, *F#*, and *G#m* are indicated.
- Guitar:** 6/8 time, playing a melodic line. Dynamics include *mf*.

The score ends with a page number 10.

MUSICAL NUMBERS

ACT I

1. Overture / The Mitten Song*
2. Life is Complete*
3. Body of Water*
4. Yoopers and Trolls
5. It Would Be a Shame
6. Dad Tax
7. Dearborn
8. Al Does the Work for Me
9. Wild Midwest
10. Fish for Mom and Dad
11. Time Does Heal
12. Gichigamiin (The Great Lakes Ballet)*
13. The Starving Artist
14. Fraudway
15. Kick Rocks

ACT II

16. Hands Come in Handy*
17. Petoskey*
18. North South East West
19. Natural Beauty
20. Rock Bottom
21. Family's in the Fossils
22. Leave No Stones Unturned
23. Water to My Soul*
24. Michigan*

GENRE

Folk, Gospel, Hip Hop, Jazz, Pop, Rock

LEGEND

Feature* Comedic Ballad Love Song
"I Want" Song Sad Insanity Linked Score

DAVID'S MUSIC SAMPLES

"Photosynthesis" – *TURNOVER: A NEW LEAF* (0:45)

One of his "sugar rush" songs that would mold "Dad Tax."

"Crunch" – *ELLIPSES* (4:30)

This may inspire the sound of the feature song, "North South East West."

"Airborne" – *CHEMICALS IN THE WATER* (5:40)

An encouraging song that may inspire "Leave No Stones Unturned."

"Cutting Edge" – *ELLIPSES* (6:29)

His "I Want" song that may inspire "Heirlooms" and "Dearborn."

"Big Bang" – *ELLIPSES* (linked here)

A crazy score that may inspire "Affordable" and "Fraudway."

DavidQuang.com/Reel



DAVID AND THE MACGREGORS ON HARBOR DAYS

HARBOR DAYS

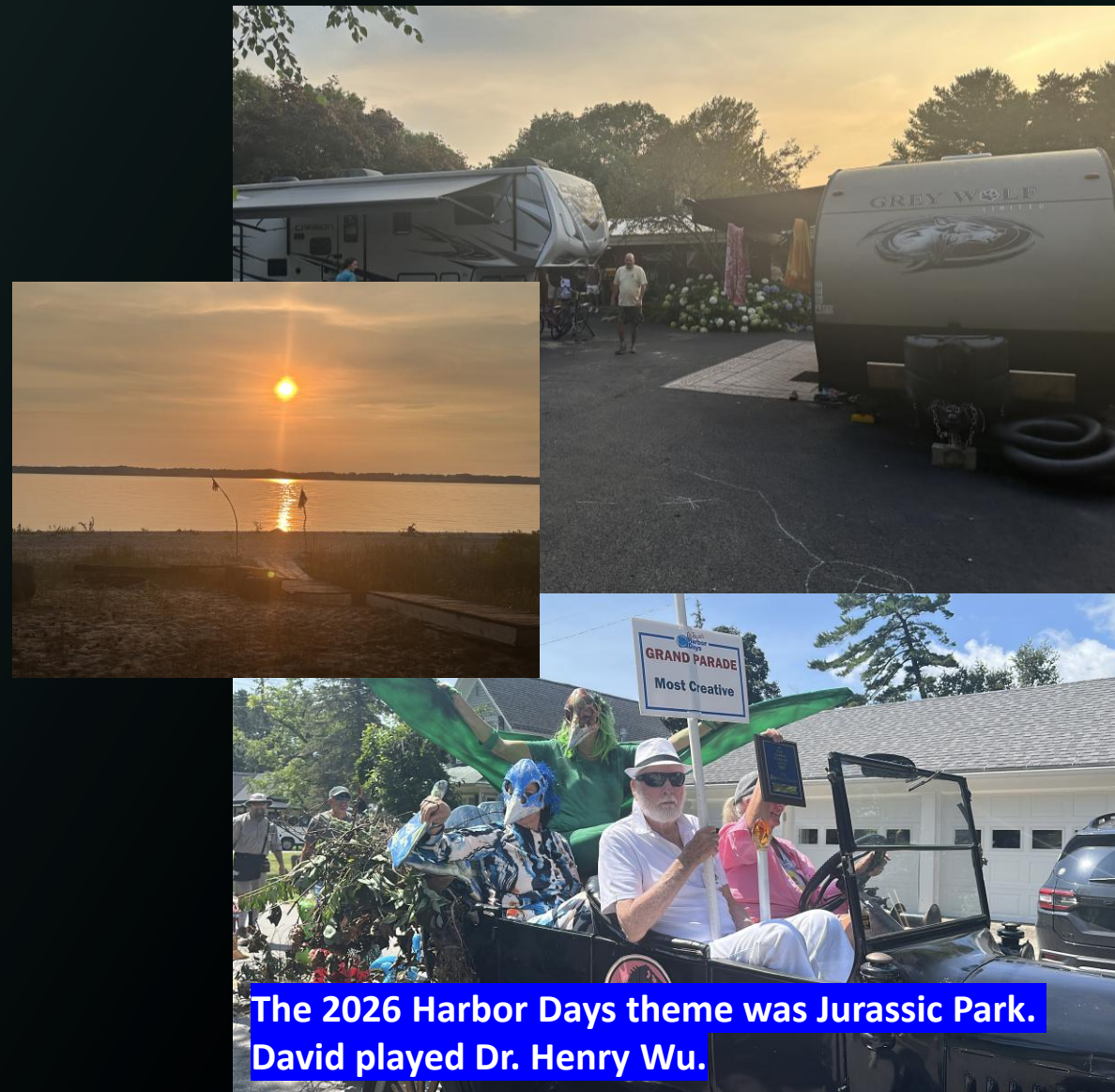
A four-day community festival held annually in August in downtown Elk Rapids, Michigan. Voted a favorite northern Michigan tradition, it celebrates community spirit with events like the Grande Parade, fireworks, and a carnival.

GRANDE PARADE

A half-mile parade with a lineup of custom floats, marching bands, nonprofits, and the award-winning MacGregor family who dress up in themes each year!

ELK LAKE HOUSE

The real-life MacGregor lake house has a multi-acre house and many acres of backyard space that meets the Traverse bay lakefront. They are the proud owners of a century-old Ford Model T.



The 2026 Harbor Days theme was Jurassic Park.
David played Dr. Henry Wu.

DATA CENTERS HURT MICHIGAN AND THE EARTH

NOISY BUILDINGS HURT WILDLIFE

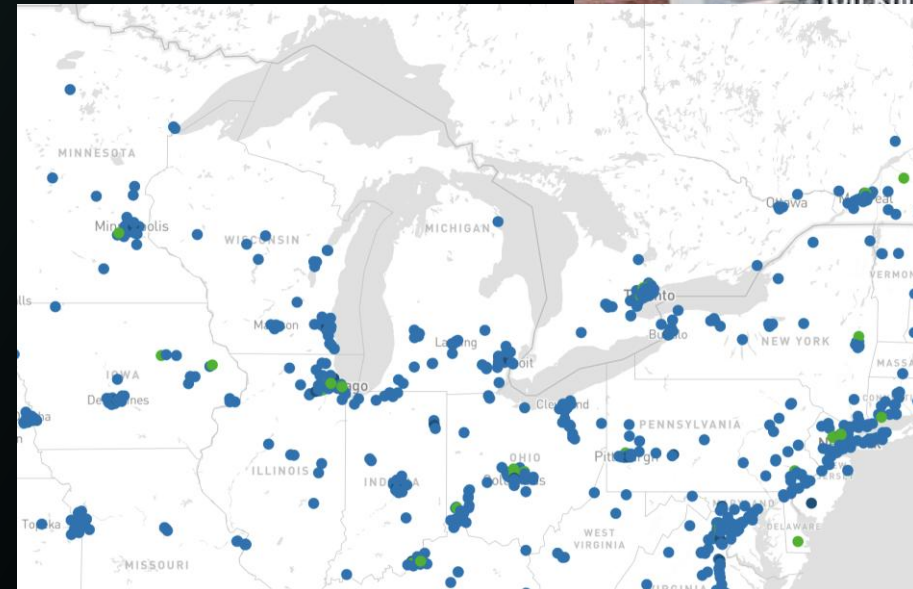
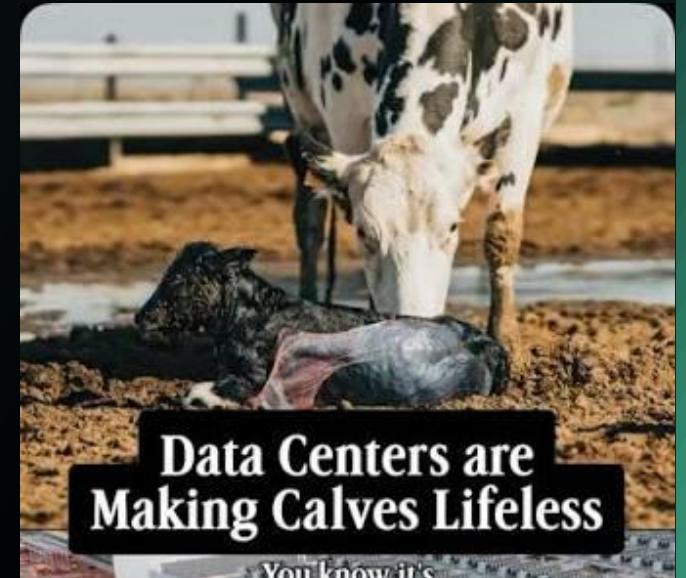
Ranchers in Texas report that low-frequency hums and vibrations from nearby data and energy centers cause severe stress in livestock, leading to claims of weight loss, breeding disruption, and stillborn calves.

EXPANSION IN THE GREAT LAKES REGION

Tech companies committed billions of dollars, such as Microsoft's \$20 billion campus in Mount Pleasant, Wisconsin, and others in northern Indiana, due to abundant water. This racks up the local electric bills.

DATA CENTERS FORCE OUT HOMEOWNERS

Homeowners in regions like Georgia are facing pressure to sell their properties as utility companies use eminent domain to build massive new power lines for data centers.



COMPS

Oklahoma craziness



Fun Home tenderness



Bright Star folksiness





2003 Space Camp,
Huntsville, Alabama



Michigan State Uni.
Astrophysics, 2014-18



Andrea M. Ghez,
Nobel Prize, Physics



David Built an
Astronaut Costume



VP of ΣΠΣ, physics
honor society



King Arthur, his knights
conquered England!

~AND SPEAKING OF STAR~

DAVID QUANG PHAM

דָּוִד קוֹוּאֲנֶג פֿאַרם

9X - 7I > 3(3X - 7U),
SCIENCE!



David managed
a greenhouse
at MSU,
2015-16

An award-winning songwriter, filmmaker, and science educator. His work engages the public in scientific and cultural literacy and are within fantasy, adventure, sci-fi, and queer genres. He created the series *Photosynthesis*; *Star Zoos*; *The Sugarcoats*; and *Solid, Liquid, and Gas*; and the stage musicals *Chemicals in the Water*, *Ellipses*, and *Turnover: A New Leaf*. His musicals have been staged regionally, Off-Broadway, and internationally. He is the 2026 Cinephilia fellow, Kellogg's Foundation film fellow, 2024 Great Performances fellow, 2022 Harriet Tubman Effect Institute composer, 2021 Playwrights Foundation fellow, and 2020 Working Title Playwrights apprentice. Pham received a BS with honors in astrophysics and theatre from Michigan State University. Be up to lightspeed at www.science.studio or @ScienceTheatre.

www.Science.Studio

